existing tri-service Andaman and Nicobar Command (ANC) was to be subsumed in any one of the maritime theatres. The overall rationale was 'One Theatre—One Threat'. However, within the land theatres, Northern Command was temporarily kept out due to the ongoing CI/CT situation and live LC and LAC, besides the fact that it faces both Pakistan and China. Reports circulating that this 'Theaterization' had to be completed within two years gave a false sense of urgency. Just evolving from Divisions and Brigades to IBGs had taken five years from ideation to roll-out. To expect Theaterization in two years was unrealistic. Even if a proposal acceptable to the three Services were to get prepared in two years, it would have been a great achievement. The burden of expectations was actually an impediment.

This proclamation by the CDS and the formulation suggested did not find favour with all. Gen Rawat had discussed these formulations with me, as I am sure he would have done with the other two Chiefs. I was okay with it although I pointed out that keeping Northern Command temporarily out of the picture would complicate matters pertaining to jointness. At least for planning purposes, we should go in for two theatres, a Land Theatre Command (West) facing Pakistan, and a Land Theatre Command (North) facing China. Northern Command of necessity would get split into two, with the J & K portion going to LTC (W) and Ladakh to LTC (N). The Navy felt that the entire maritime domain should be one only, and rather than Peninsular Command, which they felt gave it a continental tinge, they wanted it to be called the Maritime Theatre Command. The Air Force felt that they were being left out and wanted an operational Air Defence Theatre Command. These observations stemmed more from a preconceived notion that the Land Theatre would go to the Army, Maritime to the Navy and Air

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